

GRE Vocabulary Notes: Group 12

Group 12 Vocabulary

1. Acrimonious

Meaning: Angry, bitter, or harsh in tone.

Tip to remember: Acrimonious sounds like “acid.” Acid burns, and acrimonious words emotionally burn people.

Sentence: The debate became acrimonious when both sides started attacking each other.

2. Belligerent

Meaning: Hostile, aggressive, or eager to fight.

Tip to remember: Belligerent sounds like “battle.” A belligerent person is ready for battle.

Sentence: His belligerent attitude made the discussion difficult.

3. Beneficent

Meaning: Kind, generous, and doing good.

Tip to remember: “Bene” means good. Beneficent people do good things for others.

Sentence: The beneficent donor helped many poor students continue their education.

4. Canny

Meaning: Clever, careful, and good at making practical decisions.

Tip to remember: Canny sounds like “can.” A canny person can handle situations smartly.

Sentence: The canny investor avoided risky companies.

5. Cavalier

Meaning: Careless or dismissive about serious matters.

Tip to remember: Think of someone casually waving away a big problem. That careless attitude is cavalier.

Sentence: His cavalier attitude toward safety worried the engineers.

6. Distressed

Meaning: Extremely worried, upset, or suffering.

Tip to remember: Distressed means under stress. When stress is high, you feel distressed.

Sentence: She was distressed after hearing the bad news.

7. **Dwindling**
Meaning: Gradually becoming smaller or fewer.
Tip to remember: Think of a candle slowly burning down. Its size is dwindling.
Sentence: The village was worried about its dwindling water supply.
8. **Eclipse**
Meaning: To overshadow or make something seem less important.
Tip to remember: In an eclipse, one object hides another. In GRE, eclipse means to outshine or overshadow.
Sentence: Her latest achievement eclipsed all her previous successes.
9. **Encyclopedic**
Meaning: Having very wide and detailed knowledge.
Tip to remember: An encyclopedia contains knowledge about many topics. Encyclopedic means knowledge like an encyclopedia.
Sentence: The professor has an encyclopedic knowledge of power systems.
10. **Exacerbate**
Meaning: To make a problem, pain, or situation worse.
Tip to remember: Exacerbate sounds like “extra bitter.” It makes a bad situation extra bitter.
Sentence: Poor planning can exacerbate traffic problems in cities.
11. **Exasperated**
Meaning: Extremely annoyed or frustrated.
Tip to remember: Exasperated sounds like “extra irritated.” It means very frustrated.
Sentence: The teacher became exasperated after repeating the same instruction many times.
12. **Fungible**
Meaning: Interchangeable or replaceable with another identical item.
Tip to remember: Money is fungible: one Rs. 100 note can be replaced by another Rs. 100 note.
Sentence: Oil is largely fungible because one barrel can replace another of the same quality.
13. **Hackneyed**
Meaning: Overused and no longer interesting or original.
Tip to remember: Think of a joke repeated so many times that nobody laughs anymore. That joke is hackneyed.
Sentence: The essay was full of hackneyed phrases about hard work.
14. **Incongruous**
Meaning: Strange because it does not fit with the surroundings or situation.
Tip to remember: Incongruous means “not congruent.” It does not match.
Sentence: His casual clothes looked incongruous at the formal ceremony.

15. **Interchangeable**
Meaning: Able to be exchanged or used in place of each other.
Tip to remember: Interchangeable means you can change one item with another without much difference.
Sentence: In this circuit, the two identical resistors are interchangeable.
16. **Laconic**
Meaning: Using very few words; brief and concise.
Tip to remember: Think of a person who replies only “yes,” “no,” or “fine.” That person is laconic.
Sentence: His laconic answer confused the interviewer.
17. **Lucrative**
Meaning: Producing a lot of money or profit.
Tip to remember: Lucrative sounds like “loot creative.” A lucrative job brings money.
Sentence: Renewable energy has become a lucrative field for investors.
18. **Magisterial**
Meaning: Authoritative, dignified, or impressive.
Tip to remember: Think of a magistrate or master speaking with authority. That tone is magisterial.
Sentence: The judge gave a magisterial explanation of the law.
19. **Onerous**
Meaning: Difficult, heavy, or burdensome.
Tip to remember: Onerous sounds like “on us.” A heavy duty on us feels burdensome.
Sentence: The final-year project became onerous near the deadline.
20. **Opprobrium**
Meaning: Harsh criticism, public shame, or disgrace.
Tip to remember: Think of public blame being thrown at someone. Opprobrium means public disgrace.
Sentence: The corrupt leader faced public opprobrium.
21. **Parsimonious**
Meaning: Extremely unwilling to spend money; stingy.
Tip to remember: Think of a person who parts with money very slowly. That person is parsimonious.
Sentence: The parsimonious manager refused to buy necessary equipment.
22. **Peripheral**
Meaning: Not central or main; on the edge.
Tip to remember: Peripheral vision is side vision, not central vision. So peripheral means side or secondary.
Sentence: The speaker ignored the main issue and discussed peripheral details.

23. **Provocative**
Meaning: Causing strong reaction, anger, or interest.
Tip to remember: Provocative comes from provoke, meaning to stir up a reaction.
Sentence: The article made a provocative claim about education reform.
24. **Renounce**
Meaning: To formally give up, reject, or abandon something.
Tip to remember: Think of publicly announcing, “I reject this.” That is renouncing.
Sentence: He renounced his claim to the property.
25. **Tempestuous**
Meaning: Stormy, violent, or full of strong emotions.
Tip to remember: Tempest means storm. Tempestuous means storm-like.
Sentence: Their tempestuous relationship was full of arguments.
26. **Tenable**
Meaning: Able to be defended or supported by evidence.
Tip to remember: Think of an argument that can “stand on ten legs.” It is strong enough to defend.
Sentence: His theory is tenable because it is supported by data.
27. **Transgression**
Meaning: A violation of a rule, law, or moral principle.
Tip to remember: Transgression means crossing a line that should not be crossed.
Sentence: Cheating in an exam is a serious transgression.
28. **Urbane**
Meaning: Polished, refined, and socially confident.
Tip to remember: Urbane sounds like urban. A well-mannered city gentleman may be urbane.
Sentence: The urbane speaker handled every question gracefully.
29. **Verisimilitude**
Meaning: The appearance of being true or real.
Tip to remember: “Veri” means truth and “similitude” means similarity. Verisimilitude means similarity to truth.
Sentence: The realistic details gave the novel verisimilitude.
30. **Vitiate**
Meaning: To weaken, spoil, or make something ineffective.
Tip to remember: Vitiate sounds like “violate.” If you violate the quality of something, you vitiate it.
Sentence: A serious error can vitiate the results of an experiment.